

STEP BY STEP
Students at NLSIU, Bengaluru

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measured too. For instance, the UGC recently developed the Undertaking Transformative Strategies and Actions in Higher Education (UTSAH) portal to track qualitative reforms by higher education institutions.

Such monitoring is important for achieving equity in the distribution of quality education, and the India Today Group's annual rankings of the country's best universities have been performing that role for a decade now. It not only fosters a competitive spirit among universities but also helps students and parents choose the right institute on the basis of rich information and data.

The survey, conducted by the research agency Marketing and Development Research Associates (MDRA), has emerged as a credible resource on the academic and infrastructural state of Indian universities because of its robust methodology. Its acceptance is visible from the fact that the number of participating universities has grown from 120 in 2019 to 166 this year.

The results of our survey show that universities from north and south India dominate the top ranks. For instance, among the top 20 government general universities, seven are from the north and nine from the south—the same as last year. Among the top 20 private general universities, 12 are from the

THE UNIVERSITY ECOSYSTEM

TYPE OF UNIVERSITY	TOTAL NUMBER
CENTRAL UNIVERSITIES	56
STATE UNIVERSITIES	466
DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITIES	125
PRIVATE UNIVERSITIES	446
TOTAL	1,093